

DOSSIER Varesh Ashkar



Character background

The Spear That Carried the Sun — The Life of Varesh Ashkar

0 — The Name Given Before the Burden

Varesh Ashkar was born into House Ashkar, one of Elona's oldest Sunspear families. For generations, the Ashkars had served the Order as commanders, warriors, and advisors, carrying a reputation built upon sacrifice and loyalty. Their name was spoken with respect throughout Sunspear ranks, and many believed the family represented the very ideals the Order was founded upon.

Yet from birth, Varesh carried another legacy.

She was born a Kalashtar, connected to a quori spirit whose memories and emotions flowed into her own. Unlike ordinary people, sleep did not bring her simple dreams. Instead, she experienced visions of forgotten places, ancient voices, and fragments of lives that felt both foreign and strangely familiar. Her dreams were never entirely her own.

As a child, she often dreamed of a woman standing beneath a broken temple, a woman who carried the same name her father had chosen for her.

Varesh Ossa.

Karim Ashkar had chosen the name deliberately. He believed names carried responsibility, and that history was not something to fear but something to overcome. Varesh Ossa had been remembered as a figure of betrayal and corruption, someone who had once possessed great purpose but lost her way.

Karim wanted his daughter to redeem the name.

He told her:

"A name is not a prophecy. It is a challenge."

To him, Varesh Ashkar would prove that a person could carry a troubled legacy and transform it into honour.

However, the name haunted her.

In her dreams, she saw both Varesh Ossa and Kormir.

Kormir appeared as the ideal she wished to become: the mortal who endured blindness, betrayal, and suffering but still chose to protect the world.

Varesh Ossa appeared as the warning: the hero who believed she understood what needed to be done and slowly lost herself trying to save others.

She never knew whether these dreams were guidance from her quori spirit, memories of something older, or warnings of what she could become.

But they shaped her entire life.

1 — The Ashkar Household



Varesh was raised under two different interpretations of the Sunspear ideal.

Her mother, Nadijeh Ashkar, believed that the purpose of strength was compassion. She taught Varesh that mercy was not weakness and that even the smallest acts of kindness could preserve someone's humanity. Nadijeh often told her:

"Even the desert blooms when someone remembers to water it."

Her father, Karim Ashkar, believed something different.

Karim was a respected Sunspear commander who had dedicated his life to protecting Elona. He was not a cruel man, nor did he hate mercy. His tragedy was that he believed mercy without consequence could become another form of failure.

He believed a Sunspear's greatest duty was preventing suffering before it happened.

If one innocent life could be saved by a difficult choice, then that choice had to be made.

If one enemy could destroy a hundred lives, then hesitation was unforgivable.

Over time, Karim took one Sunspear virtue and pushed it beyond its meaning.

Duty became obedience.

Discipline became control.

Protection became possession.

He loved his children, but he believed love meant preparing them for a world that would show them no mercy.

Varesh accepted this.

She believed suffering was part of becoming strong.

She believed endurance was honour.

She believed carrying pain silently was what heroes did.

Her older sister, Samira Ashkar, did not.

2 — The Night Samira Left

Samira was everything Varesh was not.

She was more open, more rebellious, and more willing to question the traditions her family followed. She loved the Sunspears, but she believed the Order had lost sight of the people it existed to protect.

She saw how Karim's teachings had changed.

She saw how fear had replaced compassion.

She saw that their father no longer asked whether a decision was right.

Only whether it was effective.

Samira eventually decided to leave.

Not because she hated the Sunspears.

Because she still believed in what they were supposed to be.

She believed leaving was the only way to remain true to herself.

The night she fled, she reached the edge of the village carrying only what she could take with her. She intended to disappear before dawn, leaving behind the Ashkar name and everything attached to it.

But Karim was waiting.

He had discovered her plan.

He confronted her before she could leave.

Their argument was not between a father and a daughter who hated each other.

It was between two people who both believed they were protecting something.

Karim believed Samira was abandoning her duty.

Samira believed Karim had forgotten what duty meant.

She told him:

"You taught us to protect people from monsters. You never noticed when you became one."

Karim could not accept this.

Not because he lacked love for her.

Because accepting it meant admitting he had failed.

The confrontation ended violently.

Samira escaped, but not unharmed.

Karim struck her with his spear, leaving a deep scar along her left arm.

It was not intended as a killing blow.

But it became the final proof of what their family had become.

Varesh witnessed everything.

She saw her sister disappear into the darkness.

She saw Karim standing alone.

She knew Samira was alive.

And she said nothing.

3 — The First Secret

The following morning, Karim told the Sunspears that Samira had been killed during the night.

He claimed she had been attacked by wolves while travelling beyond the village.

To support his story, he presented a bloodied piece of her clothing, torn and marked as evidence of the attack.

Nobody questioned him.

Why would they?

He was Karim Ashkar.

A respected Sunspeaker commander.

A man who had served Elona faithfully.

Varesh knew the truth.

She knew the blood on the garment was not from wolves.

She knew the scar on Samira's arm came from her father's spear.

She knew her sister had fled because she could no longer endure their home.

But she remained silent.

Because telling the truth would destroy her family.

Because telling the truth would destroy her father.

Because leaving already felt like betrayal.

This became the first great secret of Varesh Ashkar's life.

The first time she chose loyalty over truth.

4 — The Perfect Sunspear (present time)

Determined to prove that the Ashkar name could still represent honour, Varesh devoted herself completely to the Sunspears.

She became everything the Order admired.

She was disciplined without cruelty.

Strong without arrogance.

Compassionate without weakness.

She remembered the names of refugees she rescued. She visited wounded soldiers long after battles ended. She listened to prisoners when others only saw criminals.

Her greatest belief became:

"Justice without mercy becomes vengeance."

The older Sunspears saw in her the spirit of what the Order had always intended to be.

The younger Sunspears saw the person they hoped to become.

Some believed she would one day become Marshal.

Varesh never wanted that.

She only wanted to prove she was worthy of the spear.

World buidling: character future

5 — The First Crack in the Spear

Her beliefs were first tested when the Sunspears captured a raider responsible for countless deaths across Elona.

Many soldiers wanted immediate execution.

Varesh refused.

She argued that the Sunspears could not abandon mercy simply because mercy was difficult.

The prisoner was spared.

He escaped.

Months later, he returned and destroyed another settlement.

Among those killed was Varesh's mentor, the person who first taught her that compassion was strength.

When Varesh found the destroyed village, the raider looked at her and said only one word:

"Mercy."

The word remained with her forever.

Because she learned something terrifying.

Mercy was not wrong.

But mercy had consequences.

6 — The Weight of the Order

Varesh continued serving the Sunspears, becoming one of their greatest Paragons.

But she began seeing the same pattern she had seen within her family.

Small compromises.

Small secrets.

Small sacrifices made for understandable reasons.

A noble protected because his influence was useful.

A commander hiding failure to preserve morale.

A leader making a cruel decision because they believed the alternative was worse.

She began asking:

"Who protects people from those who believe they are protecting them?"

The question frightened her.

Because it was the same question that haunted her childhood.

7 — The Bloodstone Beneath the Sand

Years later, during an expedition into forgotten Elonian ruins, Varesh discovered a Bloodstone.

It was not a weapon.

It was not a treasure.

It was forbidden knowledge.

The Bloodstones represented the gods' decision that some power was too dangerous for mortals to possess.

Standing before it, Varesh thought of her family.

She thought of the Sunspears.

She thought of every person who had ever decided that others were not ready to know the truth.

The gods.

The Order.

Her father.

Everyone who claimed secrecy was protection.

She understood why the Sunspears would hide it.

That was what terrified her.

Because she could understand both sides.

For the first time in her life, Varesh made a choice against the principles she had sworn to uphold.

She lied.

She reported:

"Nothing important was found."

And just like with Samira years before...

she convinced herself that hiding the truth was protecting others.

8 — The Spear Without a Banner

Knowing the Sunspears would eventually discover the Bloodstone, Varesh left the Order.

She told herself it was temporary.

She was still a Sunspeaker.

She still carried the spear.

She was simply searching for answers nobody else could find.

But the truth was different.

For the first time, she was not following orders.

She was following herself.

She travelled with a group of misfits who did not know her reputation.

A former Corsair captain.

A scholar who studied forgotten civilizations.

A thief who admitted his flaws rather than hiding them behind honour.

And a former Sunspeaker who had already done what Varesh feared most.

Left.

They saw not the perfect Paragon.

They saw the woman beneath the armour.

And slowly, Varesh began discovering who she was without the Order.

9 — The Voice Beneath the Stone

The Bloodstone became more than an artifact.

It became a solution.

A way to prevent suffering.

A way to make sure no more people died because someone hesitated.

Her victories became impossible to deny.

With the Bloodstone's power, she saved lives that would have otherwise been lost.

People began believing she was right.

The dangerous part was that she was.

At least sometimes.

The Bloodstone did not corrupt her by making her evil.

It corrupted her by making her effective.

And through the writings of Abaddon, she found ideas that frightened her because they sounded familiar.

Abaddon did not tempt her with domination.

He tempted her with certainty.

He asked why she continued allowing suffering when she had the ability to stop it.

And in her dreams, Kormir warned her.

Varesh Ossa encouraged her.

One told her:

"Power without humility will destroy you."

The other whispered:

"You were given the power because you were the only one willing to use it."

And slowly, Varesh began to wonder which voice was truly trying to save her.

Maps and their impact on the character

Istan — Who she was

The perfect Sunspear.

Mercy.
Tradition.
Hope.

Vabbi — Who she could have been (home)

The woman beneath the armour.

Art.
Friendship.
Love.
Knowledge.

Kourna — What she fears becoming

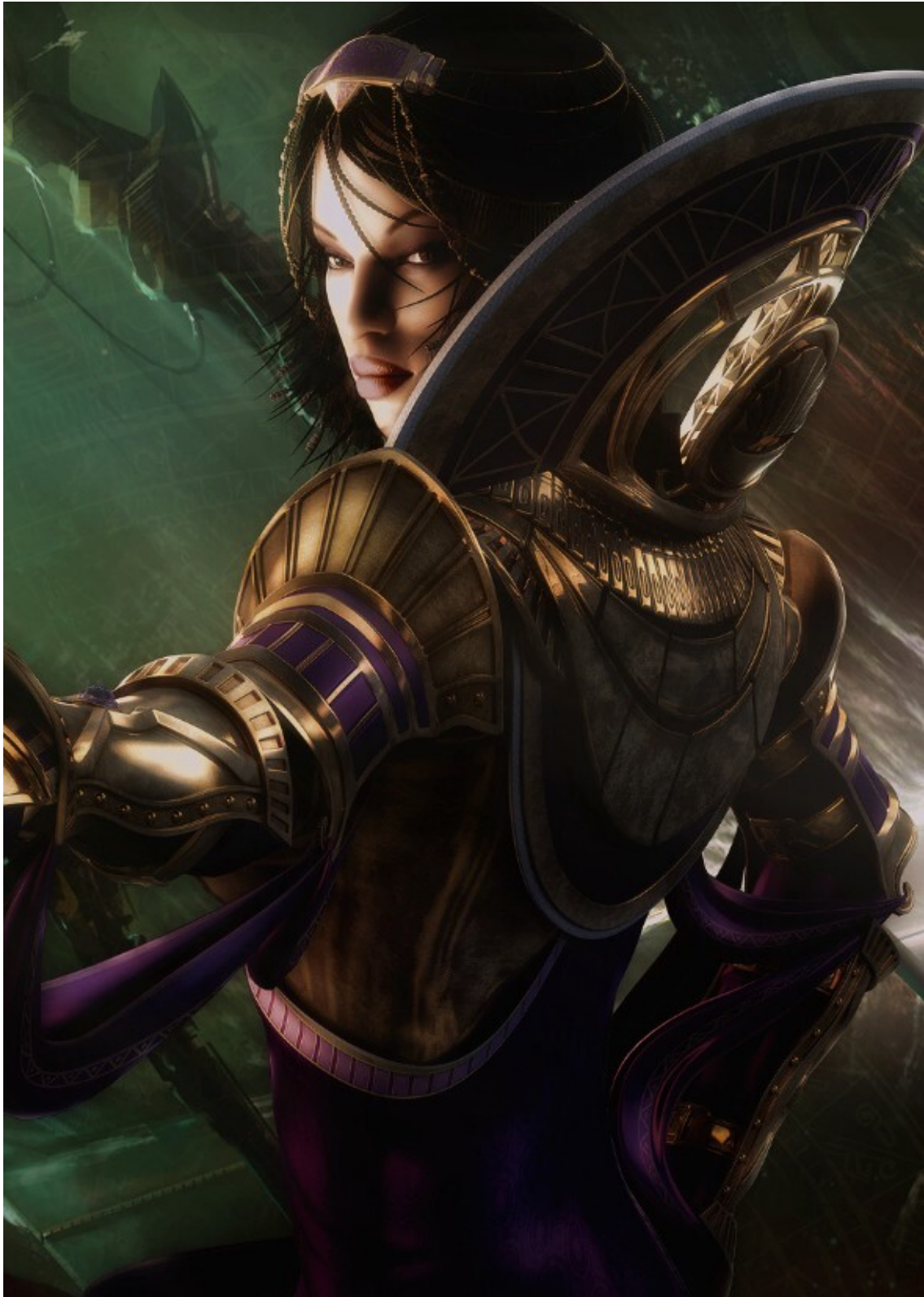
A person who values order over compassion.

Karim's philosophy.

Desolation — What she becomes

The place where knowledge, power, and certainty consume her. Abaddon's whisper.

VARESH OSSO



VARESH ASHKAR



ALLIES & ORGANISATIONS

The Sunspear Alliance (The Golden Network)

1. The Order of the Sunspears

Role: Military order / protectors of Elona

Relationship with Varesh: Home, faith, eventual conflict

The Sunspears are the central organisation.

They are an ancient order founded to protect Elona from threats both physical and supernatural. They are independent from the provincial governments, answering primarily to their own leadership and Spearmarshal. Their creed revolves around virtues such as valor, humility, honour, honesty, justice, compassion, sacrifice, and loyalty. (wiki.guildwars2.com)

For Varesh, the Sunspears are not simply an army.

They are a religion.

They are the closest thing she has to a family after Samira leaves.

This creates the strongest conflict later:

She is not rebelling against something she hates.

She is betraying something she loves.

The Three Provinces of Elona

Elona does not function as one unified kingdom. It is divided into three major regions, each with its own identity and leadership, while the Sunspears operate across all of them. (wiki.guildwars2.com)

For your D&D campaign, I would make each province have:

- a governmental body
 - a military faction
 - a relationship with the Sunspears
 - a different opinion on Varesh
-

2. Istan — The Island of Beginnings

Government:

The Istani Royal Court

Capital: Kamadan

Role: Naval power, trade, ancient traditions

Relationship with Sunspears: Extremely close

Istan is where the Sunspears are most beloved.

Historically, the Sunspears protected Istan during disasters like the Scarab Plague, evacuating civilians and restoring settlements afterward. (wiki.guildwars.com)

For Varesh, Istan represents the ideal version of the Sunspears.

A place where:

- soldiers help farmers
- commanders know villagers by name
- temples and people exist together

Key allies:

The Istani Royal Navy

A natural ally of the Sunspears.

They protect:

- trade routes
- coastal villages
- against Corsairs

Possible character:

Admiral Zahir al-Marin

A naval commander who respects Varesh but later distrusts her Bloodstone research.

The Priests of Balthazar and Kormir

Religious authorities who advise Sunspear leadership.

This creates interesting tension because after Abaddon's return, many religious figures become fearful of forbidden knowledge.

3. Kourna — The Land of Discipline

Government:

The Kournan Military Council

Capital: Gandara

Role: Army, agriculture, military tradition

Relationship with Sunspears: Respectful but tense

Kourna is perfect for your story.

Kourna understands Karim Ashkar.

They value:

- order
- sacrifice
- strength
- military discipline

A Kournan commander might secretly agree with Karim's philosophy.

This creates a great ideological conflict:

The Sunspears say:

"Strength exists to protect the weak."

Kourna says:

"Strength exists so weakness does not destroy us."

Potential ally/rival:

General Kahyet's old military faction

Before Nightfall, Kourna had strong military traditions. Some commanders might believe Varesh's Bloodstone power is exactly what Elona needs.

They become the people saying:

"Why fear the weapon that saves us?"

4. Vabbi — The Land of Knowledge and Nobility

Government:

The Vabbian Grand Princes

Capital: The Forum Highlands / the estates of the princes

Role: Wealth, scholars, magic, ancient knowledge

Relationship with Sunspears: Complicated

I think House Ashkar should come from Vabbi.

This fits your story almost perfectly.

Why?

Because Vabbi is the province of:

- ancient secrets
- scholars
- magical research
- aristocratic families
- old traditions

The Bloodstone discovery feels much more natural here.

A family like House Ashkar could be:

"One of the old Vabbian Sunsphear families who produced generals and historians."

They are not simply soldiers.

They are guardians of knowledge.

Which makes Varesh's discovery more tragic.

Because her family believes they protect history...

while hiding history.

House Ashkar of Vabbi

Role:

Ancient Sunsphear noble family.

Known for:

- commanders
- historians
- diplomats
- Paragons

Symbol:

A golden spear crossing a desert flower.

Motto:

"Stand beneath the sun, carry the burden."

Potential Vabbian allies:

The Astral Scholars of Vabbi

A fictional academic organisation inspired by Vabbian scholars.

They study:

- ancient gods
- forgotten magic
- lost civilisations

They are the people who help Varesh translate Abaddon's texts.

External Organisations

These are where your story becomes much richer.

5. The Order of Whispers

Role: Intelligence organisation

Relationship with Sunspears: Ally but secretive

Absolutely include them.

The Order of Whispers is one of the best choices because they already fit the themes of your story. They work in secrecy, gather forbidden knowledge, and often have information that governments and armies do not. During Nightfall, they become allies of the Sunspears after Varesh Ossa's rise. (wiki-en.guildwars2.com)

They are perfect for your Bloodstone arc.

Because they ask the same question Varesh asks:

"How much truth can the world handle?"

Possible character:

Master Selim Voss

Whispers agent.

He knew about Varesh Ossa.

He knows what happened to Samira.

He suspects Karim lied.

But he never reveals everything because information is his weapon.

His relationship with Varesh:

At first:

"Trust nobody."

Later:

"You became exactly what we feared."

6. The Priory of Vabbi (Precursor to Durmand Priory)

Since this is D&D rather than strict GW timeline, I would adapt this.

Role:

Archaeologists.

Researchers.

Historians.

They are fascinated by the Bloodstone.

Unlike the Sunspears, they do not fear knowledge.

Their philosophy:

"A secret buried is a disaster waiting to happen."

They tempt Varesh intellectually.

Not emotionally.

They make her think:

Maybe the Sunspears are too afraid.

7. The Centaur Tribes of Elona

Especially the Veldrunner Centaurs.

The Sunspears historically gained unexpected allies among groups normally considered enemies. (wiki-en.guildwars2.com)

For your story:

They represent outsiders who judge Varesh by actions rather than reputation.

A centaur companion could say:

"Humans spend their whole lives proving they are honourable. We simply see what they do."

8. The Corsairs

Role:

Criminals, smugglers, explorers.

Perfect for your misfit crew.

They know:

- forgotten ruins
- hidden routes
- forbidden markets

They also challenge Varesh.

They ask:

"Why do you trust institutions that lie?"

9. The Zaishen Order

Role:

Religious warriors / monster hunters

Potential ally.

They have similar themes:

- devotion
- fighting supernatural threats
- divine purpose

But they are also more fanatical.

They might admire Varesh's power too much.

10. The Forgotten / Ancient Elonian Civilisations

Not an organisation exactly, but very important.

These are:

- ruins
- abandoned temples
- lost gods
- forgotten magic

They are where Varesh finds:

- Bloodstone
- Abaddon texts
- answers about Varesh Ossa

ELONIAN MAP KNOWLEDGE

ISTAN

"The Birthplace of the Sunspears"

Culture: Naval, traditional, heroic

Government: Clanmarshals

Symbol: The beginning of the journey

Istan is the island province of Elona and the homeland of the **Order of the Sunspears**. It is a place of ancient ruins, old traditions, and military honour. The region contains remnants of the Primeval Dynasty, meaning that everywhere you walk there are reminders of forgotten greatness. (wiki.guildwars.com)

For a Sunsppear like Varesh, Istan is almost sacred. It represents the ideal version of the Order before politics and compromise affected it.

Kamadan, Jewel of Istan

Role: Capital city and Sunsppear gateway

Kamadan is the largest port city of Istan and the main entrance to Elona for foreign travellers. It is a place of merchants, sailors, diplomats, and soldiers. It is also where many outsiders first encounter the Sunspears. (wiki.guildwars.com)

Varesh connection:

Kamadan is where Varesh first experiences the wider world beyond House Ashkar.

It is where she:

- trains with other Sunspears
- meets foreign heroes
- studies old histories
- hears stories of Kormir

Later, it becomes the place where rumours about her Bloodstone research begin spreading.

Sunspear Great Hall

Role: Spiritual and military centre

The heart of the Sunsppear Order.

This is where:

- new recruits train
- commanders meet
- victories are celebrated
- fallen Sunspear are remembered

Varesh connection:

This is where Varesh becomes the Sunspear everyone expects her to be.

It is also where she feels the greatest pressure.

The walls remember heroes.

She fears becoming the wrong kind.

The Astralarium

Role: Observatory and centre of learning

A place dedicated to studying the stars, history, and ancient knowledge.

Varesh connection:

Perfect place for her Kalashtar nature.

She would spend nights here studying:

- forgotten civilizations
- divine history
- prophecies
- ancient texts

This is likely where her fascination with forbidden knowledge begins.

Fahranur, The First City

Role: Ancient Elonian ruins

One of the oldest cities in Elona, dating back to earlier civilisations.

It represents the mystery of the past.

Varesh connection:

A perfect location for the discovery of the Bloodstone.

She finds evidence that history has been hidden before.

This reinforces her belief:

"The truth has always been controlled by those with power."

KOURNA

"The Nation of Soldiers"

Culture: Military, discipline, loyalty

Government: Military leadership

Symbol: Duty taken too far

Kourna is the southern military province of Elona. It is known for its armies, agriculture, and strict devotion to order. Kournans value loyalty and service, but their culture can become rigid and authoritarian.

Kourna is the closest reflection of Karim Ashkar's worldview.

Gandara, The Moon Fortress

Role: Capital and military stronghold

Gandara is one of the most important cities in Kourna. It is a massive fortress-city and symbol of military authority.

Varesh connection:

This is where Varesh sees the danger of pure military thinking.

Kourna asks:

"What must be sacrificed to keep people safe?"

Istan asks:

"How do we protect people?"

The difference slowly becomes important.

Jahai Bluffs

Role: Historic battlefield region

A region famous for major conflicts in Elonian history, including the battles against Palawa Joko.

Varesh connection:

This is where she studies legendary battles.

She admires commanders who saved thousands.

But she also begins questioning:

How many civilians were sacrificed for those victories?

Kodash Bazaar

Role: Trade centre

A marketplace representing the civilian side of Kourna.

Varesh connection:

A good place for her to interact with ordinary people.

It reminds her that nations are not only made of armies and leaders.

VABBI

"The Land of Beauty and Knowledge"

Culture: Wealth, art, philosophy

Government: Merchant princes

Symbol: Knowledge without responsibility

Vabbi is the wealthy northern province of Elona, famous for its merchant princes, luxury, gardens, scholars, and artistic achievements. It is considered one of the richest regions in Tyria.

This is where I would place House Ashkar.

Why?

Because Vabbi creates a perfect contrast:

A family obsessed with honour living among people obsessed with knowledge, beauty, and legacy.

The Kodash Bazaar

Role: Great marketplace

A place of:

- merchants
- scholars
- travellers
- rare artefacts

Varesh connection:

This is where she meets people like Jaleh ibn Rashad.

It is the place where she learns that life is not only duty.

The Garden of Seborhin

Role: Vabbian gardens

A symbol of Vabbian luxury and beauty.

Varesh connection:

This is where she secretly relaxes.

She sketches plants here.

Writes poetry.

Practices calligraphy.

It represents the life she could have had.

The Veiled Desert

Role: Ancient mysteries

A place filled with forgotten ruins.

Varesh connection:

A location for hidden archives and ancient texts.

THE DESOLATION

"The Wound of Elona"

Culture: Survival

Government: None

Symbol: The consequences of forbidden power

The Desolation is a corrupted wasteland between Elona and the Realm of Torment. It is a region shaped by ancient magic, demons, and the legacy of Abaddon.

This is where Varesh's story becomes darkest.

The Bone Palace

Role: Fortress of Palawa Joko

A symbol of undead rule.

Varesh connection:

A reminder that tyrants often claim they are bringing order.

This mirrors her own fears.

The Crystal Desert Border

Role: Ancient Forgotten territory

A place connected to the Forgotten and Ascension.

Varesh connection:

A place where she researches:

- gods
- magic
- ascension
- Bloodstones

THE REALM OF TORMENT

"The Prison of a God"

Not technically a city, but essential to Varesh's story.

The Realm of Torment is the domain connected to Abaddon and the Margonites.

It represents:

- divine punishment
- forgotten history
- corrupted knowledge

For Varesh, this is the place where she discovers that the enemy she feared may have been more complicated than history claimed.

Important Smaller Settlements

Place	Region	Importance
Champion's Dawn	Istan	Sunspear training grounds
Chahbek Village	Istan	Rural Istani life
Beknur Harbor	Istan	Naval connection
Jokanur Diggings	Istan	Archaeological ruins
Pogahn Passage	Kourna	Military route
Yohlon Haven	Kourna	Coastal settlement

Place	Region	Importance
Jennur's Horde	Vabbi	Ancient ruins and secrets
The Mirror of Lyss	Vabbi	Religious/philosophical site
Mihanu Township	Vabbi	Civilian Vabbian life

KNOWLEDGE

I. Sunspear Teachings

The knowledge that shaped her

The Sunspear Codex

Type: Order manuscript

Origin: Sunspear archives

A collection of teachings, military doctrine, and philosophical writings passed between generations of Sunspears.

Contains:

- The Sunspear oath
- Duties of Paragons and Commanders
- Rules of engagement
- Treatment of prisoners
- Protection of civilians
- Stories of legendary Sunspears

Varesh studies this from childhood.

Her favourite section:

"The strength of a spear is not measured by what it pierces, but by what it prevents from being harmed."

Over time, she begins noticing contradictions between the written ideals and the actions of the Order.

Symbolism:

The ideal versus reality.

The Oath of the Spear

Type: Sunspear ceremonial scroll

A scroll recited during the initiation of new Sunspears.

The oath teaches:

- sacrifice
- humility

- obedience
- mercy
- protection

Varesh memorises it completely.

Later, during her crisis with the Order, she rereads it repeatedly, searching for whether she has misunderstood it or whether the Order has changed.

Symbolism:

The promise she cannot abandon.

The Chronicle of Kormir

Type: Historical record

A collection of accounts about Kormir's mortal life before becoming a goddess.

It focuses not on her divinity, but her humanity.

Varesh studies:

- Kormir's leadership
- her blindness
- her betrayal
- her sacrifice

She is fascinated that Kormir was not perfect.

She was simply someone who continued despite failure.

Symbolism:

The hero she wants to become.

II. Elonian History

The knowledge of the world before her

The Histories of Elona

Type: Royal archive collection

A series of texts documenting the history of:

- Istan
- Kourna
- Vabbi
- ancient kingdoms
- the Primeval Dynasty

Varesh reads these as a child.

She loves the stories of forgotten rulers and ordinary people who shaped history.

Jaleh often jokes:

"You are the only person I know who reads military reports for pleasure."

Symbolism:

Her belief that every person matters.

The Forgotten Tablets of the Crystal Desert

Canon inspiration: Forgotten civilization

Ancient inscriptions left by the Forgotten.

They contain knowledge about:

- the gods
- ascension
- magic
- ancient civilizations

Varesh becomes fascinated by how much knowledge disappeared from history.

This begins her belief that perhaps some truths were hidden rather than lost.

Symbolism:

The beginning of her questioning.

The Book of the Five Gods

Type: Religious text

A theological record describing the human gods:

- Balthazar
- Dwayna
- Grenth

- Lyssa
- Melandru

Varesh studies it because she believes understanding the gods is necessary to understand humanity.

Later, after learning about Abaddon, she questions whether divine history has been written by those who won.

Symbolism:

Who controls history?

III. Abaddon and Margonite Knowledge

The forbidden knowledge

The Book of Secrets

Canon: Guild Wars Nightfall

One of the most important texts in Varesh's story.

A forbidden collection connected to Abaddon, ancient magic, and forgotten truths.

The book does not immediately corrupt her.

It simply asks questions:

- Why was Abaddon punished?
- Why was knowledge considered dangerous?
- Who decided what mortals could know?

The danger is not the information.

The danger is that it validates her doubts.

Symbolism:

A truth that arrives at the wrong moment.

The Margonite Scriptures

Type: Ancient religious texts

Written by followers of Abaddon before their transformation.

They describe:

- devotion to Abaddon
- their view of knowledge
- their belief that humanity was controlled by the gods

At first, Varesh sees them as historical documents.

Eventually, she begins understanding their perspective.

The line between studying an enemy and sympathising with them begins to blur.

Symbolism:

Understanding becoming attachment.

The Testament of Abaddon

Type: Forbidden manuscript

A collection of writings attributed to Abaddon's followers.

It contains philosophical arguments rather than simple evil.

Themes:

- knowledge should not be restricted
- mortals deserve freedom
- gods should not control destiny

Varesh finds parts of it disturbingly reasonable.

This is where Abaddon's influence begins.

Not through commands.

Through conversation.

Symbolism:

The enemy who makes sense.

The Prophecies of Nightfall

Canon inspiration: Nightfall prophecy

Ancient writings describing the coming of Nightfall.

Varesh studies these after experiencing dreams of Varesh Ossa and Kormir.

She wonders whether her visions are:

- warnings
- memories
- prophecy
- corruption

Symbolism:

Fear of becoming inevitable.

IV. Ancient Magic and Bloodstone Knowledge

The knowledge that changes her

The Bloodstone Archives

Type: Ancient records

Texts describing the creation of the Bloodstones.

They explain:

- the division of magic
- the role of the gods
- the dangers of uncontrolled power

Varesh becomes obsessed with one question:

Why was humanity never trusted?

Symbolism:

The justification for her rebellion.

The Sealed Scrolls of the Six Disciplines

Type: Magical records

Ancient writings describing different forms of magic:

- Elemental power
- Necromancy
- Mesmer arts

- Ritual magic
- Divine magic
- Martial discipline

Varesh studies these because she wants to understand how power affects people.

Her Kalashtar nature makes her unusually capable of absorbing complex knowledge.

Symbolism:

Knowledge as both gift and burden.

V. Personal Writings

Varesh's own records

The Ashkar Family Journal

Type: Family record

A collection of generations of Ashkar history.

Contains:

- military campaigns
- family achievements
- Sunspear traditions

Hidden within it is the truth of Samira.

A missing entry.

A rewritten history.

Varesh eventually realises her family has always controlled its own story.

Just like kingdoms.

Just like gods.

Symbolism:

The first lie she inherited.

Varesh's Field Journal

Type: Personal diary

Begins as a record of Sunspear missions.

Early entries:

"Saved three families today. Remember their names."

Later:

"The enemy was defeated before they could strike."

Eventually:

"The sacrifice was necessary."

The language changes before she notices.

Symbolism:

Her corruption happening slowly.

The Dream Journal

Type: Kalashtar record

A book where Varesh records her unusual dreams.

Contains visions of:

- Kormir
- Varesh Ossa
- Abaddon
- forgotten temples
- unknown landscapes

She tries to determine whether they come from:

- her quori spirit
- divine influence
- inherited memory
- something else

Symbolism:

The battle inside her mind.

VI. Forbidden Knowledge She Should Never Have Found

The True Name of Varesh Ossa

Type: Ancient inscription

A forgotten record explaining Varesh Ossa beyond the historical villain.

Varesh discovers that history simplified her.

She was not born evil.

She was someone who believed she could save the world.

This terrifies Varesh.

Because it means corruption does not begin with hatred.

It begins with conviction.

Symbolism:

The mirror of her own fate.

The Last Words of Abaddon

Type: Fragmented scroll

A damaged text containing only fragments of Abaddon's final thoughts.

Not:

"Destroy the world."

But:

"They feared what I knew."

Varesh cannot stop thinking about it.

Symbolism:

The beginning of the seduction.

SUNSPEAR ARTIFACTS

I. The Objects of House Ashkar

Her childhood, family, and the first ideals she inherited

The Ashkar Family Spearhead

Type: Family heirloom

Origin: House Ashkar

A broken spearhead preserved by generations of Ashkar Sunspears. The family tradition holds that every broken weapon represents a sacrifice made in service of Elona.

Varesh keeps the spearhead as a reminder that victory always comes at a cost.

Originally, it represents honour and sacrifice.

After Samira's disappearance, it becomes something more complicated. It reminds Varesh that not every sacrifice is noble, and that sometimes people break because those closest to them failed them.

Symbolism:

The difference between sacrifice and suffering.

The Ashkar Seal Ring

Type: Family insignia

A simple signet ring bearing the Ashkar family crest.

Unlike wealthy Vabbian noble rings, it is plain and practical. Karim believed status should come from service rather than wealth.

Varesh wears it throughout her early Sunspeaker career.

Later, she struggles with whether she is protecting the Ashkar legacy or being imprisoned by it.

Symbolism:

A family name can be both a blessing and a burden.

II. The Objects of the Sunspears

Her years as the ideal Paragon

The Spear of Dawn

Type: Personal Sunspearspear

Varesh's first true Sunspearspear weapon.

It is not magical or legendary, but it is the weapon she trusts most. It represents the traditional Sunspearspear belief that a spear is not carried to conquer, but to stand between danger and the innocent.

Her father gives it to her when she joins the Order.

She later refuses to abandon it, even after obtaining more powerful weapons.

Symbolism:

Duty without corruption.

The Sunspearspear Commander's Spear

Type: Ceremonial officer weapon

Awarded after Varesh becomes recognised as a promising Paragon.

It carries inscriptions of Sunspearspear vows and is intended as a symbol of leadership.

Varesh dislikes the attention it brings, believing that leadership comes from action rather than titles.

Her commanders tell her:

"The spear is not for you. It is for those who need to know where to stand."

Symbolism:

Leadership is responsibility, not authority.

The Sunspearspear Oath Ring

Type: Ceremonial item

A bronze ring given during the Sunspearspear oath ceremony.

Unlike noble jewellery, it contains no gemstones or decoration. It represents equality among those who serve.

Varesh wears it even after secretly leaving Sunspear command structures during her Bloodstone investigation.

Others see it as hypocrisy.

She sees it as proof she never abandoned the Order.

Symbolism:

Leaving an institution does not always mean leaving its ideals.

The Sun Medal of Service

Type: Sunspear honour insignia

A medal awarded after Varesh saves civilians during a battle where another commander prioritised victory over evacuation.

She initially refuses the honour, believing she only performed her duty.

Her commander tells her:

"That is exactly why you deserve it."

Symbolism:

The person she wants to be.

III. The Objects of Kormir

Her inspiration and moral compass

The Journal of Kormir's Teachings

Type: Personal manuscript

A handwritten collection of Kormir's teachings copied by Varesh herself.

The journal contains:

- philosophical notes
- Sunspear principles
- personal reflections

- battlefield observations

The handwriting never changes.

The ideas do.

Early pages focus on:

"How do we protect people?"

Later pages become:

"How do we protect people who refuse to be saved?"

Eventually:

"How much suffering is acceptable for peace?"

Symbolism:

The slow change of her beliefs.

Kormir's Blindfold

Type: Symbolic relic

Not necessarily a magical item, but a symbol Varesh keeps.

To Varesh, Kormir's blindness represents ultimate faith:

A person who lost their sight but still chose to lead.

Later, when Varesh herself is blinded and imprisoned, the parallel becomes painful.

Kormir lost sight and gained wisdom.

Varesh loses clarity while believing she has gained wisdom.

Symbolism:

The difference between faith and certainty.

IV. The Objects of Knowledge

The beginning of her fall

The Book of Secrets

Canon: Guild Wars Nightfall artifact

An ancient text connected to Abaddon, forbidden knowledge, and forgotten history.

Varesh discovers fragments of it while investigating ancient Elonian ruins.

It does not tempt her with power.

It challenges her beliefs.

It asks:

- Why do gods hide knowledge?
- Why do leaders decide what people are allowed to know?
- Is secrecy always protection?

Symbolism:

The first crack in her faith.

The Mirror of Lyssa

Canon: Guild Wars artifact

A relic associated with illusion, identity, and perception.

Varesh becomes fascinated by it because of her own struggle between:

- Varesh Ashkar
- Varesh Ossa
- Kormir's ideal
- Karim's daughter
- Sunspear hero
- Bloodstone wielder

The mirror represents the question:

"Who am I when nobody tells me who I should be?"

Symbolism:

Identity versus expectation.

Margonite Relics

Canon inspiration: Nightfall

Fragments recovered from abandoned temples and ruins connected to Abaddon and the Margonites.

Varesh initially studies them as historical evidence.

Over time, she begins to see the Margonites differently.

Not as monsters.

As people who believed they had been betrayed.

Symbolism:

Understanding is not the same as forgiveness.

V. The Legendary Weapons

The temptation of power

The Spear of Archemorus

Canon: Guild Wars 1

A legendary spear connected to the hero Archemorus.

Varesh admires the weapon because of what it represents: sacrifice.

The spear became famous not because of destruction, but because of the courage of its bearer.

She writes:

"A weapon becomes legendary when it protects lives, not when it takes them."

Later, this belief is challenged by the Bloodstone.

Symbolism:

The hero she wants to become.

The Scepter of Orr

Canon: Guild Wars 1

Although not Elonian, the Scepter of Orr fascinates Varesh because it represents the danger of ancient knowledge and forgotten power.

It reinforces the question that eventually leads her toward the Bloodstone:

Can dangerous knowledge be controlled by someone responsible?

Symbolism:

The belief that understanding something gives you control over it.

VI. The Bloodstone

The turning point

The Bloodstone Fragment

Canon: Guild Wars lore

The artifact Varesh discovers beneath forgotten Elonian ruins.

At first, she does not see it as a weapon.

She sees it as proof.

Proof that powerful beings have always decided what mortals should know.

The gods hid magic.

The Sunspears hide truths.

Her father hid Samira.

Everyone claims:

"It is for the greater good."

The Bloodstone is the first thing that tells her:

"You are right to question them."

Symbolism:

The danger of being right for the wrong reasons.

The Bloodstone Spear

Type: Varesh's corrupted weapon

Created later by combining:

- The Spear of Dawn
- Bloodstone fragments
- Margonite inscriptions
- Forbidden knowledge

The weapon grants Varesh incredible power.

Her victories are undeniable.

She saves people.

She defeats enemies.

She becomes stronger than ever before.

That is what makes it dangerous.

If it only brought suffering, she could abandon it.

Instead, it proves effective.

Symbolism:

The greatest temptation is a tool that works.

ADDITIONAL FEATURES & TRAITS

Varesh Ashkar – Personal Traits & Habits

Names and Titles

Because of the weight the name *Varesh* carries, many of the older Sunspears avoid speaking it directly.

Instead, they affectionately call her "**Spearling**." It began when she was a young recruit who was always found polishing her training spear after everyone else had gone home. The name stayed into adulthood, though only those who have known her for years still use it.

Senior officers usually address her simply as **Ashkar**, following Sunspears custom.

Close friends sometimes shorten it to **Vae**.

Only her mother ever called her "**Little Sun**."

Her father always used her full name.

Insults

Those who wish to provoke her deliberately call her:

- **Ossa** — the most cutting insult, reducing her to the memory of Varesh Ossa.
- **Prophet's Daughter** — implying she is destined to betray Elona.
- **The Second Varesh** — whispered much later in the story.
- **False Spear** — used after rumours of the Bloodstone spread.
- **Abaddon's Paragon** — a title she fears more than death.

She never reacts immediately.

That silence usually confirms to others that the words struck home.

Personality

Varesh rarely speaks first in a conversation.

She listens.

Observes.

Only once everyone else has spoken does she quietly offer her thoughts.

She dislikes interrupting people and has a habit of letting awkward silences linger because she believes people often reveal the truth when nobody rushes to fill them.

She apologises far too often.

Even when something is not her fault.

She instinctively stands closest to the door in any room.

Old Sunspear habit.

When travelling with companions, she unconsciously counts everyone every few minutes.

Nobody notices until someone goes missing.

Habits

Whenever she is thinking deeply, she slowly spins her spear in one hand.

Older Sunspears immediately recognise this habit.

Karim did the same.

She hates that she inherited it.

She sharpens weapons that do not need sharpening.

Not because they are dull.

Because repetitive work calms her.

She drinks tea while reading.

Always.

She cannot sleep in complete silence.

If the camp is too quiet she begins hearing the voices from her dreams more clearly.

She unconsciously cleans everyone else's equipment if she wakes before dawn.

Nobody asked her to.

She simply believes shared burdens should be carried together.

Hobbies

Calligraphy

Her greatest hobby.

She learned traditional Elonian calligraphy from her mother.

She believes beautiful handwriting reflects disciplined thought.

She writes every journal by hand.

Even battle reports.

She enjoys copying:

- ancient Sunspear oaths
- poems
- old Vabbian manuscripts
- philosophical passages

Later...

she begins copying Abaddon's writings in exactly the same careful script.

This horrifies her years afterward.

Drawing

Varesh cannot draw people particularly well.

Instead she fills journals with:

- ruined temples
- desert flowers
- spearheads
- birds in flight
- old Sunspear banners
- geometric Vabbian architecture

She almost never realises that every sketchbook eventually fills with circles.

Halos.

Suns.

Eyes.

The Bloodstone.

Reading

She genuinely enjoys studying.

Her favourite subjects:

- military history
- philosophy
- diplomacy
- architecture
- ancient religions

She believes understanding a civilisation is the first step toward protecting it.

Favourite Books

The Art of War

Absolutely.

Not because she enjoys war.

Because she believes the greatest victory is preventing one.

Her favourite passage:

"The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting."

She has quoted it several times.

Ironically...

Abaddon would probably agree.

The Scrolls of Kormir

Her most treasured possession.

A collection of Kormir's teachings copied entirely by hand.

Every page contains notes in the margins.

The Histories of Vabbi

A historical account of Elonian kingdoms.

She rereads it every year.

Eventually she begins noticing how often history contradicts itself.

Favourite Music

Quiet string instruments.

Reed flutes.

Soft drums.

Music played during evenings in Vabbian courtyards.

One melody always makes her emotional.

A traditional Sunspear funeral hymn.

Her mother used to hum it while braiding her hair.

After Samira disappeared...

Nadijeh never sang it again.

Favourite Play

A Vabbian tragedy.

"The Last King of Fahranur."

A story about a ruler who slowly sacrifices every personal relationship in order to save his kingdom...

only to discover he has become the final thing destroying it.

She cries every time.

Long before she understands why.

Collections

She collects:

Broken spearheads.

Every damaged spearhead belonged to someone who survived.

She engraves the owner's name onto it before storing it.

She also collects:

Small pieces of coloured desert glass.

She keeps them inside a wooden box from her mother.

Later...

she unknowingly begins collecting pieces of ancient ruins.

Tiny fragments.

Justified as archaeology.

Actually obsession.

Food

Favourite:

- honey dates
- lamb with cinnamon
- flatbread
- mint tea
- pomegranates

She loves cooking for other people.

Not herself.

Dislikes:

Goat's milk.

Karim insisted the children drink it every morning because "comfort weakens discipline."

She still cannot stand the smell.

Animals

She loves falcons.

Their patience fascinates her.

She says:

"A falcon never mistakes waiting for weakness."

Dogs adore her.

Cats ignore her.

Camels tolerate her.

Friends

Captain Idris

A cheerful Sunspear Warrior.

Always trying to make her laugh.

She pretends he annoys her.

Everyone knows better.

Liyana

A Sunspear healer.

The only person who notices when Varesh hasn't slept.

She quietly leaves tea outside her tent.

Never mentions it.

Brother Nazeem

A Kormir priest.

Discusses philosophy with Varesh.

Eventually notices her questions changing.

He worries before anyone else does.

Jaleh ibn Rashad

"You spend so much time saving the world, Varesh. Someone ought to remind you to enjoy living in it."

Jaleh ibn Rashad is the youngest son of one of Vabbi's wealthy merchant-prince families, whose fortune was built on caravans, libraries, and trade across Elona. Unlike most of his siblings, who pursued politics and commerce, Jaleh developed a fascination with history, music, and the people who protected the realm rather than ruled it. Through diplomatic gatherings between his family and the Sunspear, he met Varesh when they were teenagers, and despite their very different upbringings, the two formed an unlikely friendship.

Where Varesh is disciplined, Jaleh is spontaneous. He enjoys fine clothes, extravagant dinners, poetry competitions, and the latest Vabbian theatre productions, and has an uncanny ability to convince Varesh to accompany him despite her insistence that she has "more important things to do." He delights in teasing her stoic nature, often joking that she was born wearing armour and has probably never knowingly broken a single rule.

Unlike many nobles, Jaleh has no desire for military glory. Instead, he believes diplomacy, art, and culture preserve kingdoms just as effectively as armies. His outlook frequently challenges Varesh's belief that duty must always come before personal happiness. Their conversations often become friendly debates between idealism and practicality, with neither ever fully convincing the other.

Beneath his playful personality, however, Jaleh is exceptionally perceptive. He notices when Varesh is exhausted long before anyone else does and is one of the few people willing to tell her that she is carrying responsibilities that do not belong to her. He has little patience for self-sacrifice when it becomes self-destruction.

As Varesh's journey grows darker, Jaleh becomes increasingly concerned by the changes in her. While others admire her growing victories, he quietly remarks that she has stopped laughing at his terrible jokes. To him, that is a far greater warning than any battlefield report.

Childhood crush

Marshal Cassian Jaleel (*working name*)

Cassian Jaleel was several years older than Samira and one of the youngest Sunspear officers to earn distinction during his early campaigns. By the time Varesh was a child, he had already become a familiar presence around House Ashkar, often training alongside Karim or accompanying Sunspear patrols through the region. To Varesh, he was everything a Sunspear should be: disciplined, patient, and quietly kind, possessing the rare ability to command respect without ever raising his voice.

As children, both sisters admired him, though in different ways. Samira challenged him constantly, questioning tactics and teasing his unwavering devotion to the Order. Cassian seemed to enjoy those conversations more than he admitted, and it became an unspoken understanding within the household that, had circumstances been different, he might one day have courted Samira. Nothing was ever declared openly, but the possibility lingered in the spaces between them.

Samira's disappearance changed that forever.

Cassian believed the official account that she had died beyond the village, and he mourned her quietly. He never spoke of his feelings, instead burying himself in service to the Sunspears. Varesh watched this from a distance, carrying the knowledge that he grieved someone who was still alive. It became another part of the secret she carried alone.

As the years passed, Cassian became both mentor and trusted commander to Varesh. Their relationship was founded on mutual respect rather than romance, yet others often mistook their closeness for something more. Varesh herself never knew whether what she felt was admiration, gratitude, or the quiet affection of someone who had loved another person for so long that it had become impossible to separate from loyalty.

For Cassian, the feelings were equally uncertain. There were moments when he looked at Varesh and saw the determined young Paragon she had become. At other times, perhaps unfairly, he caught glimpses of Samira in her expressions and mannerisms. He was careful never to blur those lines, aware that memory can make ghosts out of the living.

Neither of them ever spoke of it.

Their bond remained suspended in uncertainty, built upon years of shared campaigns, quiet conversations after battle, and a trust that neither fully understood. Had events unfolded differently, it might have become love. Instead, it remained one of the many paths Varesh never allowed herself to follow, believing that duty always came before desire.
